

5.2 Circular motion

There are many examples of objects travelling at constant speed in circles, e.g. planets, artificial satellites, charged particles in a magnetic field, etc. The physics in all these cases can be described and analysed using the ideas developed by Newton. The concepts in this section have applications in many contexts present in other sections of this specification,

such as planetary motion in section 5.4.3 (HSW1, 2, 5, 9).

This section provides knowledge and understanding of circular motion and important concepts such as centripetal force and acceleration.